

Vanessa Bell

Product Designer

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Skills

DESIGN

Product & Visual Design

Interaction Design

Information Architecture

Design Systems

Figma

Prototyping

RESEARCH

User Research

Usability Testing

Concept Validation

ENGINEERING & AI

React · React Native ·

TypeScript · Node.js ·

Claude Code

Education

Santa Clara University

B.S. Sociology · Minors in Int'l

Business & Spanish

CERTIFICATIONS

- CoCreate UX Externship
- Coursera Google UXD
- Designlab UI Design
- Coding Dojo Full Stack

Summary

Product designer and researcher who owns workflows end to end. Six years as a software engineer before moving into design, so I ramp up fast in unfamiliar codebases with Claude Code. At home in ambiguity, 0-to-1 work, and with high ownership on small teams.

Experience

Vanessa Bell Design - Product Designer & Builder

2025 - Present

Selected Engagements:

- **Product Designer & Frontend Engineer, Forma Health**
 - Sole designer for the redesign of a study configuration portal in Angular/TypeScript, oriented myself in an unfamiliar codebase with Claude Code and shipped to production - 7 PRs, 29 components.
 - Cut configuration time from 4.5 minutes to under 30 seconds for core workflow, a 9x reduction.
- **Founder, Designer & Engineer, flamencura.live (0-to-1)**
 - Designed, built, and shipped a live community events platform end to end with no engineering team: surveyed local teachers to define the feature set, then built the scraper, submission flow, and UI with Claude Code.
- **UX Lead, Research & Concept Validation, SpendLight**
 - Generative research surfaced six friction points driving abandonment of budgeting apps. Shifted product direction to reflective, judgment-free prompts, validated in usability testing.
- **UX Designer & Researcher, Talofa Games (CoCreate Cohort)**
 - Ran moderated and unmoderated usability studies (task success, time-on-task, drop-off) for a mobile fitness game. Synthesis showed the real gap was emotional engagement, not mechanical clarity.

AllStripes (health tech) - Software Engineer → Senior SWE 2020 – 2023

- Operated at the intersection of engineering and user experience, owning internal tools and patient-facing applications end to end (React, TypeScript, Postgres).
- Led the UX and technical implementation of a PDF chunking process, a 95% reduction in time to process 100-page medical records, built through rounds of trust-building with a hesitant ops team.

Cabin Technologies & Thistle - Software Engineer

2017-2020

- Shipped across the full product ecosystem at Cabin Technologies (React, React Native): consumer web, staff and driver apps, onboard IoT.
- Lead React Native developer for Thistle's iOS and Android apps.